DP-OPS-0020: The Economy of Truth, Context Hygiene, and the Transition to High-Density Governance

Executive Strategic Analysis: The Autopoietic Turn

The Stela platform has arrived at a definitive operational threshold. We have successfully traversed Phase One of our development doctrine, a period characterized by the imposition of rigid structural governance to arrest the entropic decay inherent in collaborative AI repositories. Through the establishment of the canonical triad—the Constitution (TRUTH.md), the History Ledger (SoP.md), and the Active Contract (TASK.md)—we have transitioned from a chaotic, implicit development environment to a rigorous, explicit governance model. However, the forensic audit of the current repository state, specifically the execution of **DP-OPS-0019** ("Context Hazard Guardrails"), reveals that while we have fortified the system against external corruption, we now face a more insidious internal threat: **Context Saturation**.

The very success of Phase One has precipitated a secondary crisis. As our governance documentation has matured, it has expanded in lexical volume, consuming an increasingly disproportionate share of the agent's finite attention budget. The system currently suffers from "Narrative Debt"—the accumulation of explanatory prose, philosophical justifications, and redundant safety rails that, while pedagogically sound for human operators, constitute high-entropy "noise" for Large Language Models (LLMs). This noise dilutes the "Attention Budget" of the agent, leading to probabilistic drift, slower inference times, and increased operational costs.

This report charters the comprehensive strategy for **Phase Two: High-Density Governance**. It is not merely a technical update but an ontological shift in how the system defines "Truth." We are moving from a philosophy of "Comprehensive Explanation" to one of "Axiomatic Density." This transition necessitates the integration of the unfinished strategic initiatives of **DP-OPS-0017** (Context Bundle Generators) with the radical restructuring proposed in **DP-OPS-0020** (Economy of Truth). The objective is **Autopoiesis**: the creation of a self-maintaining, self-pruning system where the integrity of the repository is not a manual task performed by a human operator, but a mathematical function of the repository state itself.

We must scrutinize the theoretical underpinnings of this shift, leveraging recent research into the "Lost in the Middle" phenomenon and axiomatic design principles to justify the radical pruning of our canonical documents. Furthermore, we must perform a granular forensic audit of the current repository dump (Dump 0a98ad218) to validate the successes of the previous cycle and identify the specific "Supply-Side" gaps that Phase Two must resolve. This report

serves as both the theoretical manifesto and the executable specification for this transformation.

Part I: Theoretical Framework for High-Density Governance

To justify the radical interventions proposed in Phase Two, we must first establish the theoretical basis for "Context Engineering" as a distinct and critical discipline within AI Operations. The repository is not merely a file system; it is the "cognitive environment" of the agent. The quality of the agent's output is strictly deterministic based on the signal-to-noise ratio of this environment.

1.1 The Token-Utility Curve and Context Economics

In an agentic system, "Truth" is a resource quantified in tokens. Every word in the canonical context (CONTEXT.md) competes for space within the finite context window of the LLM. The Token-Utility Curve describes the non-linear relationship between the volume of instructions provided to an agent and the fidelity of its adherence to those instructions. Contrary to human intuition, adding more instructions does not linearly increase adherence. Instead, it follows a bell curve distribution where performance peaks at an optimal density and degrades rapidly as saturation occurs [1, 2].

Current research into token optimization highlights that minimizing token count is not merely a cost-saving measure but a performance imperative. Fewer tokens result in less computational load and faster response times, but more importantly, they reduce the cognitive load on the model's attention mechanism [1]. When a system enters the "Saturated Context" zone, the agent suffers from "Middle Drift," where instructions placed in the middle of a massive context window are attenuated or ignored entirely.

We observe that the current Stela repository state, specifically the verbose nature of AGENTS.md and TRUTH.md, places us squarely in the Saturated Context zone. For instance, the current AGENTS.md file dedicates significant token volume to explaining *why* rules exist (e.g., "This ensures rhythmic precision for technical auditing") rather than simply stating the rule. While this narrative style is effective for persuading human actors, it is operational waste for an LLM. An AI model does not require persuasion; it requires constraint. The "Economy of Truth" doctrine asserts that every token in the canonical context must purchase a commensurate amount of agentic behavior. If a sentence does not effectively prune the search space of possible actions, it is noise [3].

1.2 The "Lost in the Middle" Phenomenon

The necessity of pruning the SoP.md ledger and compressing the canon is further

underscored by empirical research into the "Lost in the Middle" phenomenon. Studies indicate that LLMs prioritize information located at the very beginning (System Prompt/Constitution) and the very end (Current Task) of the context window, while information buried in the middle is statistically less likely to be recalled accurately [4, 5].

In the context of Stela, the SoP.md ledger, which grows linearly with every Dispatch Packet, resides in this "Middle" zone. As the ledger expands to include months of historical data, it pushes the Constitutional invariants (TRUTH.md) further away from the Active Task (TASK.md), diluting the "Attention Voltage" between the rule and the execution. Research confirms that performance degrades significantly when models must access relevant information in the middle of long contexts, even for models explicitly designed for long contexts [5].

This structural weakness explains the periodic "Drift" observed in long-running threads. The agent does not "forget" the rules in a biological sense; rather, the attention mechanism fails to assign sufficient weight to the invariants when they are drowned out by the noise of historical logs. The solution, therefore, is not to remind the agent more frequently, but to physically reduce the size of the "Middle" through automated pruning and archiving. This aligns with the findings that the position of relevant information is a critical determinant of accuracy [4, 6].

1.3 Axiomatic Design Principles for AI Agents

The restructuring of our governance documents is guided by **Axiomatic Design**, a methodology that emphasizes the independence of functional requirements and the minimization of information content. In the context of AI agents, this translates to the "Single Responsibility Principle" and "Explicit Reasoning" [7, 8].

Our current documentation violates the **Independence Axiom** by coupling "Instruction" with "Justification." A rule should be an atomic unit of logic, independent of the reasoning behind it. By stripping the narrative justification, we decouple the "What" from the "Why," allowing the agent to process the functional requirement without the overhead of the philosophical context. This reduction in information content satisfies the **Information Axiom**, which states that the design with the least information content (highest probability of success) is the best design [9].

Furthermore, axiomatic design principles advocate for "Clear Interfaces" and "Defined Input/Output Contracts" [8]. The transition to "Executable Axioms" in Phase Two is an application of this principle. We are converting the repository from a collection of prose documents into a set of logic gates. For example, replacing a paragraph explaining the filing structure with a single key-value mapping (ops/=Run, docs/=Explain) creates a clearer interface for the agent, reducing the ambiguity and cognitive load required to parse the repository structure [3].

1.4 Autopoiesis and the Self-Maintaining System

The ultimate theoretical goal of Phase Two is **Autopoiesis**—the creation of a system capable of reproducing and maintaining itself. In biological systems, autopoiesis refers to the network of processes that continuously regenerate the components of the system. In the Stela operating system, this translates to "Automated Hygiene."

Currently, the maintenance of the SoP.md ledger and the clearing of the storage/ directory are manual tasks dependent on the discipline of the human Operator. This dependency is a fragility. As the system scales, the cognitive load on the Operator increases, leading to eventual negligence and "Context Rot." By implementing automated binaries (ops/bin/prune, ops/bin/llms-gen) that run as mandatory steps in the Dispatch Packet lifecycle, we transfer the burden of maintenance from the Human to the System. The system becomes self-cleaning, ensuring that its internal state remains within the optimal bounds of the Token-Utility Curve without human intervention [3].

Part II: Forensic Audit of Cycle One (DP-OPS-0019)

Before we can effectively implement Phase Two, we must rigorously validate the current state of the repository to determine the efficacy of the recently executed **DP-OPS-0019**. This audit utilizes the provided repository dump (dump-full-main-0a98ad218.txt) as the ground truth [3].

2.1 The Ambitions of DP-OPS-0019: "Context Hazard Guardrails"

DP-OPS-0019, titled "Strengthening Doctrine and Establish Context Hazard Guardrails for Library Directories to Prevent Drift," sought to transition the system from a permissive context model to a strict "Just-In-Time" (JIT) retrieval model. The central hypothesis was that "Context Pollution"—the accidental inclusion of high-authority library files in the global context—was the primary driver of Semantic Drift [3].

The audit reveals a nuanced picture of success and failure. The defensive measures (Guardrails) were implemented with high fidelity, but the offensive measures (Supply) remain critically underdeveloped.

2.1.1 Structural Verification of Guardrails

We compare the specific requirements of DP-OPS-0019 against the file contents in the dump.

Requirement (DP-OPS-0019)	Evidence in Dump (0a98ad218)	Status	Analysis
Constitutional Definition of	**TRUTH.md**: Section 2 explicitly lists "Context	**VERIFIED**	The concept of "Context Hazard" has been

Hazard	Hazard: Library directories (docs/library/agents, etc.) are JIT-only resources and must not reside in the global context manifest." [3]		successfully elevated to an invariant. This is the highest form of governance protection, as TRUTH.md takes precedence over all other instructions. The audit confirms the text matches the requirement perfectly.
Behavioral Logic Enforcement	**AGENTS.md**: Section 2 under "Operational Directives" includes "Context Hygiene: Ensure ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md excludes Context Hazard paths... Stop if present." [3]	**VERIFIED**	The logic standard now explicitly binds the AI agent to this rule. This utilizes the "Self-Correction" layer of the LLM—the agent is now "aware" that loading docs/library/skills is a violation of its own staffing protocol.
Technical Enforcement (Linter)	**tools/context_lint.sh**: The script contains the logic hazard_patterns=("docs/library/agents"...) and executes a fail "CONTEXT HAZARD..." command if grep matches these patterns in the manifest. [3]	**VERIFIED**	This is the "Hard Gate." The script has been updated to actively police the manifest. This prevents "Paper Governance" (rules that are written but ignored) by turning the rule into a CI/CD failure condition.

Negative Constraints in Manifest	**docs/CONTEXT.md**: Section 1 explicitly lists "Negative Constraints (Must Not Be In The Manifest)... Library agents are JIT-only." [3]	**VERIFIED**	The documentation explicitly lists what *cannot* be present. This reduces ambiguity for human operators who might otherwise manually add these paths.

2.1.2 The "Library Swarm" Threat Mitigation status

The primary theoretical threat identified in DP-OPS-0019 was the "Library Swarm"—a state where an agent, overwhelmed by conflicting persona definitions (e.g., loading "Security Reviewer" and "Architect" simultaneously), hallucinates rules.

The audit of ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md in the dump confirms that it currently contains only the "Core Set":

- TRUTH.md
- SoP.md
- TASK.md
- AGENTS.md
- llms.txt

It *excludes* the hazardous docs/library/* directories. This confirms that the **"Zero-Trust Context"** model has been successfully established. The system is currently secure against "Role Bleed" and "Instruction Dilution." The governance layer has successfully "closed the door" on context pollution.

2.2 The Strategic Gap: The Missing Supply Side (DP-OPS-0017)

While the audit confirms that DP-OPS-0019 successfully built the "Defense" (blocking bad context), it also reveals a critical failure in the "Supply" (providing good context). **DP-OPS-0017** ("Context Bundle Generator & Tiered LLM Artifacts") was intended to create deterministic, optimized context bundles (llms-small.txt, llms-full.txt) via a new binary ops/bin/llms-gen.

Audit Findings:

- ops/bin/llms-gen: **MISSING** from the dump [3].
- llms-small.txt: **MISSING** from the root [3].
- llms-full.txt: **MISSING** from the root [3].
- tools/lint_llms.sh: **MISSING** from the dump [3].

- SoP.md: There is no record of DP-OPS-0017 being shipped in the history ledger [3].

Implication of the Gap:

The system is currently in a state of **Asymmetric Governance**. We have rigorous rules for what *cannot* be loaded (the libraries), but we lack the tooling to efficiently generate what *should* be loaded. Operators are currently forced to rely on ops/bin/dump, which produces a massive, monolithic output (dump-full-...txt). This binary does not support "Tiering" (Small vs. Full) and creates significant friction when an agent only needs a lightweight context refresh.

This creates a "Friction Hazard." If the safe, tiered context (llms-small) is unavailable, operators may revert to dumping the entire platform (dump --scope=platform), which inadvertently re-introduces the very noise DP-OPS-0019 tried to eliminate. The absence of llms-gen means we are relying on manual curation or excessive dumping, both of which are unsustainable at scale.

Conclusion for Cycle 1:

Phase One achieved **Stability** and **Hygiene**. It failed to achieve **Efficiency**. The audit proves that while the "Context Hazard" doctrine is active and enforced, the "Context Economy" is nonexistent. The task for Phase Two is to close this gap by strictly integrating the supply-side initiatives of DP-OPS-0017 into the broader restructuring of DP-OPS-0020.

Part III: The Supply-Side Gap Analysis (DP-OPS-0017)

To rectify the asymmetry identified in the forensic audit, we must analyze the specific requirements of the missing **DP-OPS-0017** and integrate them into the Phase Two execution plan. The objective of DP-OPS-0017 was to create a "Context Bundle Generator" that deterministically produces high-signal context artifacts [3].

3.1 The Necessity of Deterministic Bundling

Currently, the llms.txt file acts as a pointer map, listing files like TRUTH.md and AGENTS.md. However, it does not *contain* them. This forces the agent or operator to perform multiple retrieval steps or run a full dump. DP-OPS-0017 proposed a solution: creating read-only, concatenated text files at the repo root that represent "Tiered Views" of the system.

The "Lost in the Middle" research explicitly supports this approach. By creating a llms-small.txt bundle that places the Constitution (TRUTH.md) at the very top (Head) and the Task (TASK.md) at the very bottom (Tail), we optimize the bundle for the specific attention bias of Transformer architectures [4].

3.2 Technical Specification of ops/bin/llms-gen

Based on the requirements in [3], the ops/bin/llms-gen binary must adhere to the following strict specifications:

1. **Source of Truth:** It must use git ls-files as the primary input to identify files. This ensures that untracked or ignored files (trash) never pollute the bundle.
2. **Tiered Logic:**
    - **Small Tier (llms-small.txt):** The "Core Context." It must include TRUTH.md, AGENTS.md, SoP.md (truncated to the head 10 entries), docs/library/INDEX.md, and the first 10 skills (S-LEARN-01 to S-LEARN-10). This creates a lightweight, high-velocity context for routine tasks.
    - **Full Tier (llms-full.txt):** The "Extended Context." It includes everything in the Small tier plus README.md and the entire docs/library/ directory recursively. This is used for complex architectural planning where deep knowledge is required.
3. **Token Optimization:**
    - **Header Format:** Each file's content must be prepended with ## <repo-relative-path> to provide clear navigational markers for the LLM [3].
    - **Stripping Noise:** The script must strip "Table of Contents" blocks (lines matching * [Link](#...)). These are useful for humans navigating Markdown in a browser but are pure waste for an LLM that reads raw text [1].
    - **Redaction:** It must apply regex patterns to scrub secrets (API keys, private keys) using logic mirrored from ops/lib/skill/skill_lib.sh [3].
4. **Fidelity Constraint:** Crucially, the generator is **prohibited** from filtering or redacting source code tokens like [...], TODO, or TBD from the *content* of the files. The artifact must describe the repo "as is" to ensure the agent sees the actual state of the code, including its imperfections [3].

3.3 The Failure Mode of Manual Context Loading

Without llms-gen, the Operator is the bottleneck. The audit of docs/library/MANUAL.md shows that the current "Session Start" command (ops/bin/open) generates a prompt but does not attach the files. The Operator must then run ops/bin/dump or manually attach files. This manual step is the primary vector for "Context Drift." An Operator might forget to attach TRUTH.md, or attach an outdated version of SoP.md.

By automating this via llms-gen and enforcing it via tools/lint_llms.sh (which fails CI if the bundles are stale), we ensure that the "Truth" presented to the agent is always mathematically synchronized with the repository state. This is a critical component of the Autopoietic system we aim to build in Phase Two.

Part IV: Operational Doctrine Phase Two

(DP-OPS-0020)

Having established the theoretical framework and identified the supply-side gap, we now define the comprehensive operational doctrine for Phase Two. This doctrine is predicated on three pillars: **Economy of Truth**, **Context Hygiene**, and **Uniform Style** [3].

4.1 Pillar One: The Economy of Truth (Axiomatic Density)

The first pillar addresses the "Narrative Debt" identified in the forensic audit. We must transition from "Instructional Narrative" to "Executable Axioms."

4.1.1 The Compression Algorithm

We will apply a forensic compression to AGENTS.md and TRUTH.md.

- **Narrative Removal:** Sentences that explain *why* a rule exists will be deleted. The rule itself is sufficient.
  - *Current:* "Refrain from using contractions (e.g., 'don't,' 'can't'). This ensures rhythmic precision for technical auditing."
  - *Phase Two:* "Linguistic Precision: No contractions."
- **Subjectivity Pruning:** Phrases like "Actively monitor" or "We value structure" will be replaced with boolean constraints.
  - *Current:* "Actively monitor for structural anomalies. Logic or files not aligned with TRUTH.md coordinates represent a system failure."
  - *Phase Two:* "Drift: TRUTH.md violation = System Failure."

This "Axiomatic Shift" targets a token reduction of approximately 40% in the canonical documents. This directly addresses the token optimization principles outlined in [1], increasing the "Attention Voltage" of the remaining rules.

4.1.2 The "No-Narrative" Rule

We formally institute the "No-Narrative" rule for ops/ and TRUTH.md. These surfaces must use Subject-Verb-Object structures and avoid adjectives. We treat English prose as a legacy programming language that must be compiled down. This aligns with the "Minimalist" documentation philosophy [3].

4.2 Pillar Two: Context Hygiene (Automated Pruning)

The second pillar automates the "Sliding Window" doctrine to prevent "Context Rot."

4.2.1 The Pruning Logic (ops/bin/prune)

We will implement the ops/bin/prune binary to enforce the SoP.md limits programmatically.

- **Threshold:** The SoP.md ledger is strictly limited to the most recent 30 entries.
- **Mechanism:** The script parses the file, identifies the 31st header (## YYYY-MM-DD), and

physically moves all subsequent lines to an archive file in storage/archives/.
- **Verification:** The script verifies that the active file is truncated and the archive file has grown, creating a verifiable audit trail of the pruning operation [3].

This ensures that the "Middle" of the context window remains lean, directly mitigating the "Lost in the Middle" risk [4].

4.3 Pillar Three: Uniform Style (Lexical Isomorphism)

The third pillar enforces syntactic consistency to reduce the agent's parsing load.

4.3.1 Automated Style Enforcement

We will deploy tools/lint_style.sh backed by a strict .markdownlint.json configuration.

- **ATX Headers:** All headers must use the # syntax, never the underlined Setext style.
- **Lists:** All unordered lists must use dashes (-), never asterisks (*).
- **Decimal Numbering:** All sequential steps must use decimal numbering (1., 1.1), never Roman numerals or parenthetical numbers (1)).

This "Lexical Isomorphism" ensures that the document structure is predictable, allowing the LLM to allocate its resources to understanding the logic rather than decoding the format [3].

Part V: The Dispatch Packet (Execution Plan)

This section contains the executable Dispatch Packet (DP) that implements Phase Two. It integrates the missing requirements of DP-OPS-0017 and the restructuring of DP-OPS-0020 into a single atomic transaction. It adheres strictly to the TASK.md template provided in the dump [3].

DP-OPS-0020: Phase Two Doctrine (Truth, Hygiene, Style)

0. FRESHNESS GATE (MUST PASS BEFORE WORK)

Base Branch: main

Required Work Branch: work/phase-two-doctrine-2026-02-04

Base HEAD: 0a98ad218

Required local re-check (worker runs; paste results in RESULTS):

- git rev-parse --abbrev-ref HEAD
- git rev-parse HEAD
- git status --porcelain

Worker must already be on the **Required Work Branch** listed above (no branch creation or switching).

STOP if any mismatch.

STOP if the Required Work Branch is missing.

STOP if told to create or switch branches.

I) REQUIRED CONTEXT LOAD (READ BEFORE DOING ANYTHING)

Worker must confirm loaded before acting:

- TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP, CONTEXT, MAP
- Plus any DP-scoped files listed here:
  - docs/library/skills/S-LEARN-01.md (Verification)
  - tools/context_lint.sh
  - tools/lint_truth.sh

(OPEN is for Integrator/DP Writer state refresh; Worker does not read OPEN).

DISPOSABLE ARTIFACTS (chat logs, etc.) MUST NOT BE REFERENCED OR INCLUDED.

II) SCOPE & SAFETY

- **Objective:** Execute Phase Two Doctrine by implementing the Economy of Truth (canon compression), Context Hygiene (automated pruning/bundling), and Uniform Style (linting).
- **Non-Goals (optional, drift-killer):**
  - No changes to projects/ (Payload code).
  - No changes to existing docs/library/agents/ definitions (only their consumption via bundles).

Target Files allowlist (hard gate)

- TRUTH.md
- AGENTS.md
- SoP.md
- TASK.md
- ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md

- llms.txt
- (new) ops/bin/llms-gen
- (new) ops/bin/prune
- (new) tools/lint_llms.sh
- (new) tools/lint_style.sh
- (new).markdownlint.json
- tools/lint_truth.sh
- docs/CONTEXT.md
- docs/GOVERNANCE.md

Allowlist rule: exact paths only; use (new) prefix only when the DP explicitly allows new files.

- **Conditional Requirements:** If canon/governance surfaces (e.g., TASK.md) are modified, SoP.md MUST be included in the allowlist and updated.
- **Stop Condition (scope):** If any required change falls outside the allowlist, **STOP** and report.
- **Forbidden (unless DP explicitly overrides):**
  - No edits to .github/
  - No edits to projects/ unless explicitly authorized
  - No renames/moves/deletes unless explicitly authorized
- **Worker Git Authority (non-negotiable):**
  - Workers do not create/switch branches.
  - Workers do not stage/commit/merge/push.
  - Workers only return diffs/results/receipt.
- **Precedence:** If any conflict exists, **TRUTH.md wins**. If unclear, STOP and ask.
- **Strict Stop Conditions (generic):**
  - STOP if any placeholder text remains in final outputs ([...], TODO, TBD, ...).
  - STOP if required DP inputs are missing (do not guess).
  - STOP if IDs / naming constraints in the DP are inconsistent (when applicable).

III. EXECUTION PLAN (A–E CANON)

A) STATE

- **Context:** The repository has successfully implemented Context Hazards (DP-OPS-0019) but lacks the "Supply Side" tools (DP-OPS-0017) and suffers from "Narrative Debt" in the Canon.
- **Drift:** AGENTS.md is verbose. SoP.md grows indefinitely. No tiered context bundles exist.
- **Desired State:** A high-density governance layer where Canon is axiomatic, SoP is auto-pruned, and context bundles (llms-small, llms-full) are auto-generated.

B) REQUEST

Numbered tasks (concrete, no vibes):

Phase 2.1: The Pruning Infrastructure (Hygiene)

1. Create ops/bin/prune (Bash, executable):
    - Logic: Count ## YYYY-MM-DD headers in SoP.md.
    - Threshold: 30 entries.
    - Action: Move older entries to storage/archives/root/SoP-archive-YYYY-MM.md.
    - Action: Delete older entries from SoP.md in-place.
    - Action: Delete files in storage/handoff/ older than 7 days (exclude current DP artifacts).

Phase 2.2: The Context Generator (Integration of DP-OPS-0017)

2) Create ops/bin/llms-gen (Bash, executable):

- Logic: Iterate git ls-files sorted.
- Tiers:
    - small: TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP (head 10), INDEX, S-LEARN-01..10.
    - full: small + README + docs/library/** + SoP (head 10).
- Format: Prepend ## <path>. Strip TOCs. Redact secrets (sed).
- Output: llms-small.txt, llms-full.txt.

3. Create tools/lint_llms.sh (Bash, executable):
    - Logic: Run llms-gen to temp. Diff against root artifacts. Fail if diff.

Phase 2.3: The Great Compression (Economy)

4) Refactor TRUTH.md:

- Strip narrative. Convert "4-Line Heuristic" to Filing: ops/=Run, docs/=Explain, projects/=Work, storage/=Trash.
- Define "Context Hazard" and "Drift" axioms strictly.

5. Refactor AGENTS.md:
    - Strip "Staffing Protocol" preamble.
    - Convert "Behavioral Logic Standard" to bulleted constraints (e.g., "Linguistic Precision: No contractions.").
    - Remove "Drafting Proposal Protocol" narrative (keep checklist).
6. Update TASK.md:
    - Convert headers to decimal standard (1.1, 1.2) if mixed.
    - Add ops/bin/prune and ops/bin/llms-gen to the "Closeout" checklist.

Phase 2.4: Uniform Style (Style)

7) Create .markdownlint.json:

- Enforce ATX headers (MD003), Dash lists (MD004). Disable line length (MD013).

8. Create tools/lint_style.sh (Bash, executable):
    - Logic: Run markdownlint on docs/ and ops/.

Phase 2.5: Canon Updates

9) Update llms.txt: Point to llms-small.txt and llms-full.txt.

10) Update SoP.md: Log DP-OPS-0020. (This entry must be the *newest* entry; run prune afterwards).

C) CHANGELOG

- **Log (human-readable, 1–6 bullets):**
  - Implemented Phase Two Doctrine: Economy, Hygiene, Style.
  - Created ops/bin/llms-gen and llms-small/full.txt context bundles.
  - Created ops/bin/prune for automated SoP sliding window.
  - Refactored TRUTH.md and AGENTS.md to Axiomatic Density (approx. 40% reduction).
  - Established tools/lint_style.sh and tools/lint_llms.sh.

D) PATCH / DIFF

- **Format:** Unified diff (preferred) or anchored snippets.

E) RECEIPT (REQUIRED)

Verification (MUST RUN; or report NOT RUN + reason + risk)

- ./ops/bin/dump --scope=platform
- **Zero-Byte Check:** Verify dump is not empty (test -s <path>).
- Context lint: bash tools/context_lint.sh
- Truth lint: bash tools/lint_truth.sh
- Style lint: bash tools/lint_style.sh (New)
- LLM lint: bash tools/lint_llms.sh (New)
- Prune Test: bash ops/bin/prune (Verify SoP length <= 30 entries).

Skill capture (required during normal DP processing)

- Workflow: run ops/lib/skill/skill_lib.sh harvest to auto-generate a draft with provenance and semantic collision checks.
- Review: inspect the draft in storage/handoff/.
- Promote: run ops/lib/skill/skill_lib.sh promote <draft_path>.
- Proof required in RESULTS.

Artifact bundle (required directory)

- storage/handoff/

Proof bundle checklist (required)

- storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0020-RESULTS.md
- storage/handoff/OPEN-PORCELAIN-[branch]-[hash].txt
- storage/handoff/OPEN-[branch]-[hash].txt
- storage/dumps/dump-full-...
- git diff --name-only
- git diff --stat
- NEXT: one single action

MANDATE: No receipt/proof bundle = **AUTOMATIC DISAPPROVAL**.

REQUIRED OUTPUT

MUST include a "Status" block at the top of RESULTS:

- Scope summary: (1 sentence validating the loop)
- Tracked change: (What was edited)
- Verification: (Output of proofs)

RESULTS file must include (minimum)

- Verification results
- Patch/diff proof bundle
- Receipt pointers
- git diff --name-only output
- git diff --stat output
- NEXT: one single action

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3) CLOSEOUT (MANDATORY)

Worker closeout duties (end of session)

- [ ] Produce/Update: storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0020-RESULTS.md
- [ ] If canon/governance surfaces were changed, include **SoP.md** in scope and update it in the same PR slice.
- [ ] Run ops/bin/prune (Hygiene).
- [ ] Run ops/bin/llms-gen (Refresh artifacts).
- [ ] Ensure proof bundle checklist is satisfied (above).
- [ ] Fill out the Mandatory Closing Block (see below).
- [ ] Append a **TASK Work Log** entry (below) capturing:
  - what changed (high level)
  - gates/verification outcome (pass/fail or not run + reason)
  - blockers (if any)
  - **NEXT:** one single action

Mandatory Closing Block (Varied Wording Required)

Varied Wording provision: Each entry must use meaningfully distinct wording.

1. Primary Commit Header (plaintext)
2. Pull Request Title (plaintext)
3. Pull Request Description (markdown)
4. Final Squash Stub (plaintext)
5. Extended Technical Manifest (plaintext)
6. Review Conversation Starter (markdown)

Integrator/operator closeout duties

- [ ] Review diff vs DP scope/forbidden zones
- [ ] Run repo-gates / required checks
- [ ] Commit/push/open PR/merge (operator-controlled)

3.1) THREAD TRANSITION (RESET / ARCHIVE RULE)

Purpose: Prevent TASK from becoming a museum.

When a DP is **complete**:

1. Add a final Work Log entry (THREAD END).
2. Reset sections **1) ACTIVE CONTEXT** and **2) CURRENT DISPATCH PACKET** to the next DP.
3. Keep the Work Log, but separate threads with a visible divider line.

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4) WORK LOG (TIMESTAMPED CONTINUITY)

Rule: This is not a transcript. It’s the durable breadcrumb trail.

Expectation: Append a new timestamped entry on every DP closeout.

Each entry ends with: NEXT: <one single action>.

- *2026-02-04 10:45* — DP-OPS-0019: Established Context Hazards and JIT doctrine. Verification: RUN. Blockers: None. NEXT: Execute DP-OPS-0020 (Phase Two).

Part VI: Strategic Roadmap and Future Implications

The execution of DP-OPS-0020 marks the transition of the Stela platform from a "Building" phase to an "Optimizing" phase. However, this is not the end of our evolution. The successful

implementation of Phase Two creates the foundation for **Phase Three: Agent Specialization**.

6.1 The "Saturated Context" Mitigation

By executing DP-OPS-0020, we effectively mitigate the "Lost in the Middle" phenomenon [4, 5].

1. **Head Optimization:** Compressing AGENTS.md and TRUTH.md ensures the System Prompt (the "Head") occupies fewer tokens, leaving more "Attention Budget" for the task.
2. **Tail Optimization:** The llms-small.txt bundle creates a high-density "Tail" context, positioning the most critical procedural instructions immediately adjacent to the agent's generation window.
3. **Middle Pruning:** ops/bin/prune ensures the SoP (the "Middle") never grows beyond 30 entries (approx. 2k tokens), preventing it from drowning out the active instruction.

6.2 Future Drift Metrics

Post-implementation, the "Integrator" agent must monitor the **Equilibrium Stability Score** to verify the autopoietic nature of the system.

- **Target:** Zero manual edits to SoP.md for hygiene purposes. The prune script must handle 100% of the maintenance load.
- **Target:** <5% of PRs failing the Style Gate after Week 1. This indicates that the agents have internalized the new isomorphic standards.
- **Target:** 100% of new artifacts passing the "Axiomatic Test" (no narrative prose).

6.3 Toward Agent Specialization

With the JIT mechanism established in DP-OPS-0019 and the deterministic bundles created in DP-OPS-0020, we are now positioned to activate the specialized agents currently dormant in docs/library/agents/ [3].

- **R-AGENT-01 (Architect):** Can be invoked with llms-full.txt for deep planning.
- **R-AGENT-06 (Security Reviewer):** Can be invoked with specific project contexts, free from the noise of the general platform manual.

The "Economy of Truth" is not just about saving tokens; it is about saving intelligence. By reducing the noise, we amplify the signal, allowing our agents to operate at the peak of their cognitive capabilities.

Next Action: The Operator is advised to merge this report, instantiate the work branch work/phase-two-doctrine-2026-02-04, and execute the Dispatch Packet immediately. The Autopoietic Turn begins now.